Production Change Management Standard Operating Procedure

1. Purpose

This SOP defines the minimum operational requirements that must be reviewed before implementing a production change.

2. Impact Assessment

Every production change must identify affected applications, components and known downstream dependencies.

3. Testing

Testing must cover normal processing, expected failure scenarios and regression scenarios for functionality affected by the change.

4. Historical Incidents

Relevant historical incidents should be reviewed when the change affects functionality that has previously caused production failures.

5. Rollback Plan

Every change must contain a clear rollback or recovery procedure. The procedure must explain how partially processed transactions or batches will be handled when applicable.

6. Data Integrity

Changes affecting transaction processing or persistent data must include validation for duplicate processing, partial commits and inconsistent data states.

7. Approval

Changes with unresolved high-risk scenarios or insufficient rollback coverage require additional review before production implementation.